East Anglian Daily Times

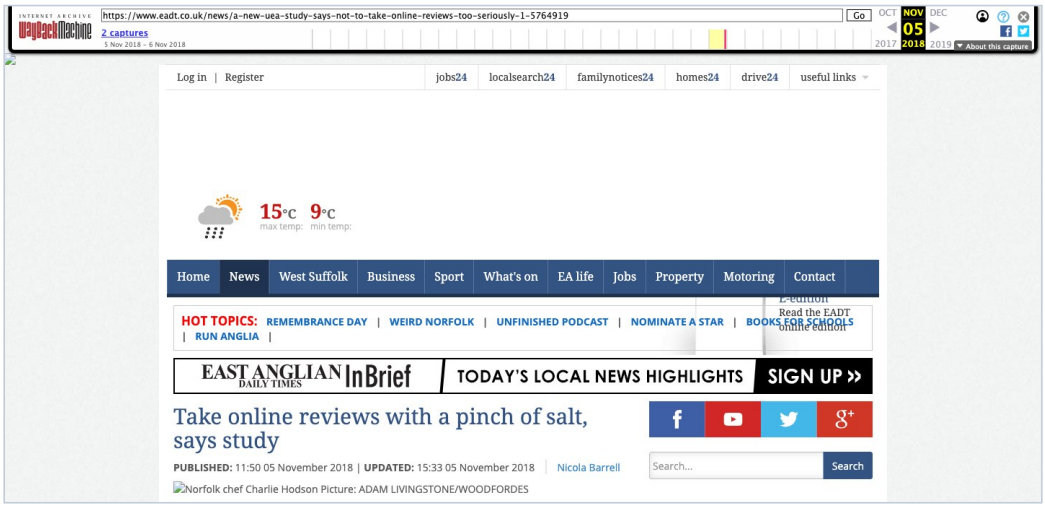
«Take online reviews with a pinch of salt, says study»

5 November 2018 · English · By Nicola Barrell. Quoted by name.

Archived copy (Internet Archive Wayback Machine, snapshot of 5 November 2018); the original page is no longer online.

https://www.eadt.co.uk/news/a-new-uea-study-says-not-to-take-online-reviews-too-seriously-1-5764919

Research. Stamolampros, P. and Korfiatis, N. (2018). Exploring the Behavioral Drivers of Review Valence: The Direct and Indirect Effects of Multiple Psychological Distances. *International Journal of Contemporary Hospitality Management*, 30(10), 3083-3099.



The researchers found the greater the distance between the home country of the reviewer and the country visited, the more positive the rating.

"We believe this is to do with the feeling that the more distant you are from your point of reference, which is connected with all the petty annoyances that you have to deal with in daily life, the more positive you are," said Stamolampros.

However, in the case of cultural distance, the relationship is the reverse. "Distance does not always lend enchantment to the view. People like the idea of visiting different cultures but do not always tolerate surprises," said co-author Dr. Nikolaos Korfiatis.

The authors say the findings have implications for both consumers and managers. They recommend that consumers should look for reviews from people who are culturally close to them, as they will be more representative of what to expect.

"People will continue to buy products and services online as faster, cheaper delivery processes are developed, and easy return and refund processes reduce the risk. As such, people will continue to consult online reviews when making their decisions," said Stamolampros.